

- The place and the price will be ideal but the dates might be 6-12 months in the future. You can't do that.
- The travel days (eg. weekdays) might not be comfortable for your friends/ family.
- You're afraid to book too early/ don't have the cash at hand.

The above 3 reasons are only the tip of the iceberg with many more concerns on safety, familial finances and biological cycles hindering plans. As tempting as it is to read '*Just quit everything and travel now*' on Facebook, it is true that travel isn't accessible to everyone. But if you're in a decent space professionally with no health issues, the money and calendar issue can be ironed out with a small change in mindset.

- First, being flexible about travel dates is key to securing a cheaper flight. That's why booking 6 months in advance is useful. You could talk to your boss several times and make the transition easier. No more flying only on weekends and spending a king's ransom on flights.
- If you have a regular income, no matter how small, then money is the least of your worries. Next chapter will show you on ways to allocate your income stream.

Now, as you've booked cheap flights, the next big expense to take care is accommodation.

Ways to find cheap accommodation

Finding cheap ways to stay is all about getting out of your comfort zone. Quite often, we have traveled with family and stayed in lodging capacities where we overpaid. A standard room in any Indian city now costs 1500 for a night. Stay for a week and your finances are drained by 5 figures already. Once you take a longer vacation, these smaller costs add up to large numbers. On the contrary, if you can find cheaper stays, the small savings add up to something that can be dispensed for a longer travel plan or for food at exotic restaurants.

I'll list down the free stays first and then small expenditure options later.

Free Stays

Just Free, No caveats